Lesson 6 Teacher's Checklist / Prep Guide

Complete before class

VIDEO GAME CREATION

This Is a Milestone Lesson

Today's exercise completes the Level 1 MVP milestone from the Semester 1 Capstone GDD - by the end of class, every student's game will have a complete, playable core loop: move, shoot, face multiple enemies, and win. Worth calling out explicitly in class; it's a real accomplishment six weeks in, not just another incremental step.

Self-Contained Lesson Assets

Everything needed for the core exercise is already in students' projects from Lessons 2-5, and the "win text" is drawn/displayed directly by each engine's own basic text tools, not an image asset. Two new placeholder sound effects were added to this lesson's Assets/ folder for the Level 3 sound idea: sfx_win.wav (victory stinger, play it the moment the win check passes) and sfx_start.wav (a game-start/announcement stinger, provided for general use).

Continuity From Lesson 5

- ☐ Remind students to open their own [YourName]Game project from Lesson 5, not create a new one - today adds a win check on top of the enemy row they already built.
- ☐ If a student's Lesson 5 project is lost or broken, have a pre-built "Lesson 5 complete" starter available per engine (from the Lesson 5 Teacher's Keys) so they aren't blocked.

Engine Verification

This week introduces each engine's simplest built-in way to show text on screen, deliberately avoiding a full UI/Canvas system - that's coming properly in Lesson 9.

- ☐ Confirm the demo laptop's Lesson 4 and 5 exercises still work for all 8 engines.
- ☐ Godot: confirm a simple Label node, hidden by default and shown via script, displays correctly.
- ☐ Unity: confirm OnGUI() with GUI.Label() actually renders in your installed Editor version (it's legacy IMGUI, still fully supported, but worth a quick check).
- ☐ GameMaker: confirm obj_enemy's Destroy event fires reliably and can reference a variable on another instance (obj_spawner.enemies_remaining) without error.
- ☐ GDevelop: confirm a Text object can be placed hidden and shown via an action in your installed version.

- ☐ TIC-80: confirm print() draws text at the coordinates you expect in your installed version - low risk, but worth a 30-second check.
- ☐ 001 Game Creator (Windows demo laptop): confirm the "Defeated / Destroyed" Actor Trigger and the "Message Box" event both work as expected - this is a different trigger than "Collided with actor" from Lesson 4, so re-verify.
- ☐ If any advanced-track students are on Unreal this week, confirm Event Dispatchers (Add Event Dispatcher, Bind Event to) work as expected in your installed version, and that Print String's "Print to Screen" option is enabled by default.

Materials

- ☐ Print or queue digital copies of all 8 Student Handouts (or confirm students can access their engine's version electronically).
- ☐ Have the 8 Teacher's Keys on hand (instructor reference only - do not distribute) in case a student needs a worked example beyond Level 1.
- ☐ Bring: demo laptop, projector cable/adapter, handout copies.

Known Gotchas This Week

- Every engine: the most common bug is an off-by-one error in the enemy count - double check the starting count actually matches the number of enemies the Lesson 5 spawn loop creates (5, unless a student changed it).
- Godot / Unity / GameMaker / GDevelop / Unreal: the win check needs to run from the code that actually destroys an enemy, not from a separate "check every frame" loop - a per-frame check is more error-prone and unnecessary here.
- Unity: OnGUI() only draws while the GameObject it's attached to is active and Play Mode is running - if nothing appears, confirm the GameManager GameObject itself wasn't accidentally deleted or disabled.
- 001 Game Creator: "Defeated / Destroyed" is a different trigger from "Collided with actor" - both belong on the enemy Actor Template, doing two different jobs (one for the entire fight, one specifically for counting down).